

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE SIXTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR PINELLAS COUNTY, FLORIDA — CIVIL DIVISION**

CASE NO. 26-002613-CI

DENNIS M. HEWETT, as Personal Representative of the Estate of Richard W. Melillo, etc., Plaintiff,

v.

BRANDI ROGERS [correctly, BRANDI LYNN RODGERS], et al., Defendants.

DEFENDANT'S STATEMENT OF CHAIN OF TITLE

(filed as part of Defendant's Answer pursuant to § 66.021(7), Florida Statutes)

Defendant BRANDI LYNN RODGERS states the following chronological chain of title upon which she will rely at trial concerning the property described as: **Lot 271, OAKHURST GROVES, according to the plat thereof recorded in Plat Book 46, Pages 16 and 17, Public Records of Pinellas County, Florida; a/k/a 13721 94th Avenue North, Seminole, Florida 33776; Parcel No. 19-30-15-62658-000-2710.**

#	Date of instrument	Grantor → Grantee	Instrument	Recording
1	June 14, 1977	Walter L. Moose → William F. Melillo	Deed	O.R. Book 4561, Page 1084, Pinellas County
2	July 9, 2020	William F. Melillo → William F. Melillo for a life estate (enhanced), remainder upon his death to Richard W. Melillo	Warranty Deed (enhanced life estate / "Lady Bird" deed) — Copy attached as Attachment 1	Recorded July 14, 2020, O.R. Book 21077, Page 809, Instrument No. 2020208528, Pinellas County
3	(death of William F. Melillo)	Remainder vested in Richard W. Melillo in fee	Death certificate of William F. Melillo (filed in Case No. 26-	—

		simple by operation of law upon the death of the life tenant	000874-ES, docket entry 5)	
4	September 13, 2025	Richard W. Melillo → Richard W. Melillo for a life estate (enhanced), remainder upon his death to Brandi L. Rodgers	Quit claim deed (enhanced life estate / "Lady Bird" deed), executed before two subscribing witnesses (Scott J. Rodgers; Christopher T. Kraft) — unrecorded ; copy attached as Attachment 2 , together with the sworn Proof of Execution of subscribing witness Christopher T. Kraft as Attachment 3 (accepted for filing June 15, 2026 in Case No. 26-000874-ES, docket entry 32)	Not recorded. Valid as between the parties and as against the grantor's heirs, devisees, and personal representative notwithstanding non-recording; § 695.01(1), Fla. Stat., protects only creditors and subsequent purchasers for value without notice.
5	October 15, 2025	Upon the death of Richard W. Melillo, the remainder vested in Brandi L. Rodgers in fee simple by operation of law	Death certificate of Richard W. Melillo (filed in Case No. 26-000874-ES, docket entry 4)	—

Pursuant to § 66.021(7), Florida Statutes, copies of the instruments identified above that are in Defendant's possession are attached. Defendant further states that the property was the protected homestead of Richard W. Melillo at his death (see the 2020 deed's recital: "THIS IS THE HOMESTEAD PROPERTY OF THE GRANTOR," and the homestead tax exemption of record through 2025), such that it never became an asset of the probate estate and the Personal Representative has no superior right of possession. §§ 733.607(1), 733.608(1)–(2), Fla. Stat.

BRANDI LYNN RODGERS, Defendant, self-represented
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Attachments: (1) 2020 Warranty Deed, O.R. 21077/809; (2) September 13, 2025 enhanced life estate deed (copy); (3) Proof of Execution of Christopher T. Kraft.